

Does Alcohol Consumption Affect Depression

Among High School Students?

YRBS 2007 | Yang Yu-Ru | Student ID: 113440033
Final Individual Project - One-page Infographic Summary

Research Question

Does current alcohol use relate to feeling sad or hopeless for two or more weeks?

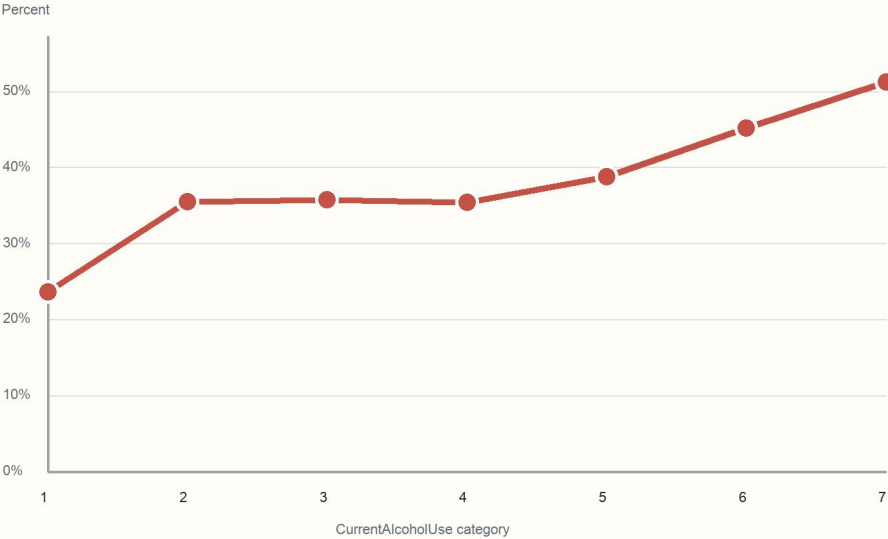
Variables

X: CurrentAlcoholUse
Y: Depression indicator
(1 = SadOrHopeless yes)

Method

Data cleaning, descriptive figures, and simple OLS regression.

Depression Rate by Alcohol Use Category



Key Results

- 12,610** students after removing missing values
- 29.4%** reported feeling sad or hopeless
- +0.044** higher depression probability per alcohol-use category
- 0.016** R-squared: small explanatory power

Interpretation

Students with higher alcohol-use categories showed a higher probability of reporting sadness or hopelessness. The relationship is statistically significant in the notebook regression, but the low R-squared means alcohol use is only one part of adolescent mental health.

Conclusion

The findings support the hypothesis that current alcohol use is associated with depressive symptoms among high school students. Prevention programs should address both substance use and mental health support.

Clean Data

drop missing values

Recode Outcome

1 = depression reported

Analyze

OLS regression

Communicate

figures + summary

Note: SadOrHopeless was recoded so 1 = reported feeling sad or hopeless; the original variable appears coded in the opposite direction. Results are observational and do not prove causation.